

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Multi-Session VCDs?

Q I have Nero 6.0.1. Please tell me how I can write video files (in VCD format) onto a multi-session CD, so that I can add video files the next time I write to the CD. I want to run the CDs on a VCD player.

Also, when a video file is on the hard drive, a certain size is displayed, say 630 MB. But when I add this to Nero for writing in the VCD format, it shows a much smaller size (like 580 MB). Why?

Chatendra Dev

A It is possible to create multi-session VCDs or even DVDs using Nero. The problem is that the VCD created may not be playable on your VCD player, since it will not be compliant to the standards set by the VCD industry. You will still be able to play it on your computer.

Most standalone VCD players can read only the first session of a VCD—the remaining sessions will remain inaccessible to the player. Some new VCD players support multi-session VCDs, but since you haven't specified what VCD player you have, you'd do best to burn a VCD in a single session.

MPEG-1, used in VCDs, provides 352 x 240 at 30 fps, 15-bit colour, and CD-quality sound. So your video files get converted to MPEG-1. If you're burning, say, an uncompressed video file, the size may reduce to as much as 10 per cent of the original! Similarly, if you're burning a DivX movie, it gets upsampled since it's more compressed than MPEG-1, and you'll see a larger file size in Nero.

There are two other things to consider here: first, a VCD is burnt in Mode 2/XA instead of ordinary data mode. This mode has less error correction than data mode, so some of the space reserved on the CD for error correction can be used to store data. Second, a larger DAT file on the hard disk appears lower-sized on a VCD because some of the data is stored in the sub-channel area of the CD.

Mad At My Modem

Q I recently bought a v.92 56.6 kbps Krypton internal modem for my AMD Athlon64 3000+ based PC with Windows XP SP2. The modem only generates noise and never connects, whereas it works fine on other PCs.

Abhishek

A Read the modem manual and set the appropriate modem initialisation string and also the country setting. Sometimes, the country setting might not be "India"; you might have to use trial and error to figure the correct country setting. If that doesn't work, uninstall the drivers and install the latest drivers from the manufacturer's Web site. You can also try to lower the baud rate of the modem to, say, 33.6 kbps and then try to connect. If it does connect, there's surely a noise problem with your telephone line, and you'll need to contact your phone company to find a solution. Also try plugging the modem into a different PCI slot.

DD:MM:YY/HH:MM:SS

Q When writing files to CD using Windows Explorer in XP, the date and time of the files change to the current date and time. Is there a setting that can prevent this change so that the original values are retained?

Dr Kiran K Kalra

A When you copy a file to CD, a new file is created on the CD, so the "Created" date and time is set to the current date and time. Bear in mind that the "Modified" date and time remain the same as in the original. This cannot be changed using just XP.

You might want to use Nero Burning ROM for burning CDs: you have three options—to retain the original date and time, to set them to the current values, or even to set custom values!

My Music's Running Away!

Q I have an Intel 845GL chipset-based motherboard with a Celeron 2.4 GHz processor and an AC'97 supported audio device. I'm running Windows 98. My problem is that is the speed of the audio—the tempo—is faster than normal. What can I do?

Sanjay

A The problem of audio playback at a higher tempo is caused if you install the audio drivers for AC'97 audio devices before you install the chipset drivers for your Intel motherboard, or if you have not installed the chipset drivers at all. Download the latest drivers for your audio and motherboard chipset from the manufacturer's Web site. We recommend that you download the latest chipset drivers for your motherboard from www.intel.com, which is mentioned as an INF Update utility. The current version is 6.3.0.1007.

Uninstall the audio driver you've installed. Install the motherboard chipset driver you downloaded. Then install the audio driver, and your problem should be solved.

An Obscure Error Message

Q I recently installed Internet Information Server. The problem is that whenever I click on Default Web Site, I get the 0x8ffe2740 error. What does this